SUZU TRAVELS · PRIVATE TOUR OF INDIA

Himachal Pradesh in 10 days: Shimla, Manali, Dharamshala, Dalhousie and Khajjiar

Toy train to Shimla, Manali, McLeod Ganj and Dalhousie — planned from our home state — a sample plan we build from; every night can move.

Day by day

DAY 1 — **Arrive in Delhi**

Your driver meets you at Delhi airport — name, photo and car number are shared with you before the trip. A quiet evening to get over the flight; the mountains start tomorrow.

DAY 2 — **Delhi → Kalka → toy train to Shimla**

An early train or drive north to Kalka, then the narrow-gauge Kalka–Shimla railway: 96 km (60 mi) of curves, bridges and tunnels, part of UNESCO's "Mountain Railways of India" since 2008. Your car carries the luggage and meets you at Shimla. Prefer the road? Shimla is 370 km (230 mi) from Delhi — a full day. More in our toy train guide.

DAY 3 — **Shimla**

The town on its ridge: the Mall and the Ridge on foot, Christ Church, and a walk up to the Jakhu temple if you have the legs for it. An easy day at altitude before the longer drives.

DAY 4 — **Shimla → Manali**

260 km (162 mi) north through the Kullu valley — a full day with stops. We leave after breakfast and arrive before dark.

DAY 5 — **Manali: Solang and the Atal Tunnel**

Solang valley is 13 km (8 mi) from Manali. When the road is open, the 9.02 km Atal Tunnel, at about 3,000 m (9,800 ft), takes you through to Sissu in Lahaul, which it keeps connected to Manali all year.

DAY 6 — **Manali: Old Manali, Hadimba, or Rohtang in season**

A slower day: Old Manali, the Hadimba temple, cafés by the river. From May to November you can instead ride up to Rohtang Pass, 51 km (32 mi) away — it needs a vehicle permit and is closed by heavy snow from late November until May.

DAY 7 — **Manali → Dharamshala**

A full-day drive west into the Kangra valley, into the foothills of the Dhauladhar range. Check in at McLeod Ganj, above Dharamshala.

DAY 8 — **McLeod Ganj**

At 2,082 m (6,831 ft), McLeod Ganj is the seat of the Tibetan Government in exile and the Dalai Lama's home since 1959. The main temple, the monasteries, Bhagsu, and Tibetan food in the evening. Our McLeod Ganj guide has the details.

DAY 9 **Dharamshala → Dalhousie and Khajjiar**

A full-day drive to Dalhousie, the hill station founded by Lord Dalhousie in 1850 as a summer retreat, with its Mall Road and old churches. Then about 22–24 km to Khajjiar, a saucer-shaped meadow at about 1,980 m (6,500 ft) ringed by forest. If the drive runs long, we move Khajjiar to the morning of Day 10.

DAY 10 **Down to the plains and home**

To Pathankot, 87 km (54 mi), for the train to Delhi; or to Amritsar, 199 km (124 mi), to fly or to add the Golden Temple; or to Kangra (Gaggal) airport, 110 km (68 mi). We time the drive around your train or flight, with a margin.

What is included — and what is not

- **Included.** Private air-conditioned car and the same English-speaking driver for all 10 days, fuel, tolls, parking and state taxes; 9 hotel nights with breakfast in the tier you choose; the toy-train ticket Kalka–Shimla (seasonal, where running); airport pick-up in Delhi and the final drop.
- **Not included.** International flights, the India e-Visa, the Rohtang vehicle permit if you choose that day, entry tickets, lunches and dinners, tips. Local guides in Shimla or McLeod Ganj can be added to the same quote.
- **Cars.** Sedan for 2–3 travellers, SUV for 4–6 — we use SUVs in winter and for families. Your driver's name, photo and car number are shared with you before the trip.
- **Run from Himachal.** Our office is in Bilaspur district, Himachal Pradesh. We plan this route ourselves, watch the weather and road reports during your trip, and you have our office WhatsApp number throughout.

Prices

Himachal — 10 days / 9 nights (this itinerary)	**on request**	Private car and driver throughout, 9 hotel nights with breakfast, toy train Kalka–Shimla (seasonal), airport pick-up in Delhi and final drop; guides and tickets on request
Golden Temple & Himalayas — 10 days / 9 nights (Delhi · Amritsar · Dharamshala · Manali)	**from US$949**	Per person, two sharing: comfortable 3-star hotels with breakfast, private car and driver. International flights not included.
Golden Triangle + Himalayas — 12 days / 11 nights (Delhi · Agra · Jaipur · Shimla · Manali)	**from US$1,099**	Per person, two sharing: comfortable 3-star hotels with breakfast, private car and driver; UNESCO toy train to Shimla (seasonal, where running). International flights not included.

Prices are per person in US dollars, indicative, and confirmed on your quote. You receive a day-by-day plan with a US-dollar total and what it covers before you pay anything.

How booking works

20% deposit locks your dates and price; full refund if cancelled within 48 hours of paying; balance before the trip; pay by card via Razorpay (international cards accepted) or PayPal.

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